

Real Batteries and Voltmeters

Assignment 4

SCIE 001 Physics

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Introduction and Description

For this assignment, you essentially only need to finish what you started in tutorial, where you investigated the internal resistance of a battery and of your voltmeter. Your submission should include two figures along with a brief description of your method and discussion of your results.

1. Battery internal resistance

1.1. Methodology

[100 words max] Briefly explain your methodology (e.g. how you chose to vary the resistance: potentiometer? resistors?, over what resistance range? how did you measure the resistance value?, how did you determine your uncertainties?)

Resistance over a 9 volt battery was varied from 1 Ohm to 2 M Ohms by combining various small resistors on a breadboard. Voltage across the resistance was then measured with a digital multimeter (DMM). To gain further accuracy and account for the resistance of the breadboard, resistances were also measured with a DMM.

Uncertainties were propagated from the uncertainty reported in the DMM's manual.

Include a reference from the manual

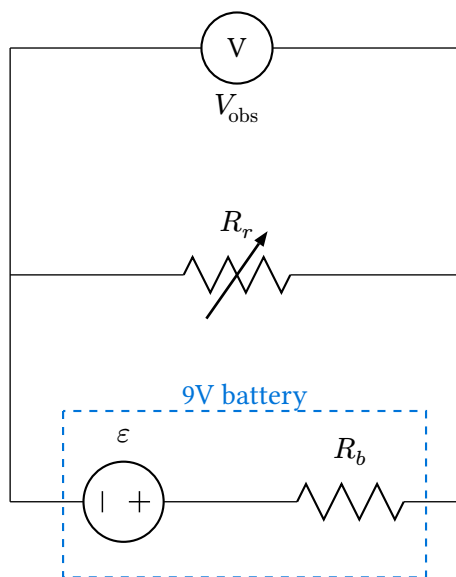


Figure 1: A circuit diagram of the setup.

subtract these words from the count

$$V = IR$$

$$I = \frac{V_{\text{obs}}}{R_r}$$

“Define the variables here”

$$u[I] = \sqrt{\left(u[V_{\text{obs}}] \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial V_{\text{obs}}} \frac{V_{\text{obs}}}{R_r}\right)\right)^2 + \left(u[R_r] \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial R_r} \frac{V_{\text{obs}}}{R_r}\right)\right)^2}$$

$$u[I] = \sqrt{\left(\frac{u[V_{\text{obs}}]}{R_r}\right)^2 + \left(u[R_r] \frac{-V_{\text{obs}}}{R_r^2}\right)^2}$$

From this:

$$V = IR$$

$$\varepsilon = I(R_r + R_b) \quad V_{\text{obs}} = IR_r$$

$$\varepsilon - IR_r = IR_b$$

$$\varepsilon - V_{\text{obs}} = IR_b$$

$$\therefore I = -\left(\frac{1}{R_b}\right)V_{\text{obs}} + \frac{\varepsilon}{R_b}$$

Or in other words, in the linear relationship between I and V :

$$\text{Slope} = m = -\frac{1}{R_b}$$

$$\therefore R_b = -\frac{1}{m}$$

$$u[R_b] = \sqrt{\left(u[m]\left(\frac{\partial}{\partial m}\left(-\frac{1}{m}\right)\right)\right)^2}$$

$$\therefore u[R_b] = u[m]\left(\frac{1}{m^2}\right)$$

Words: 83

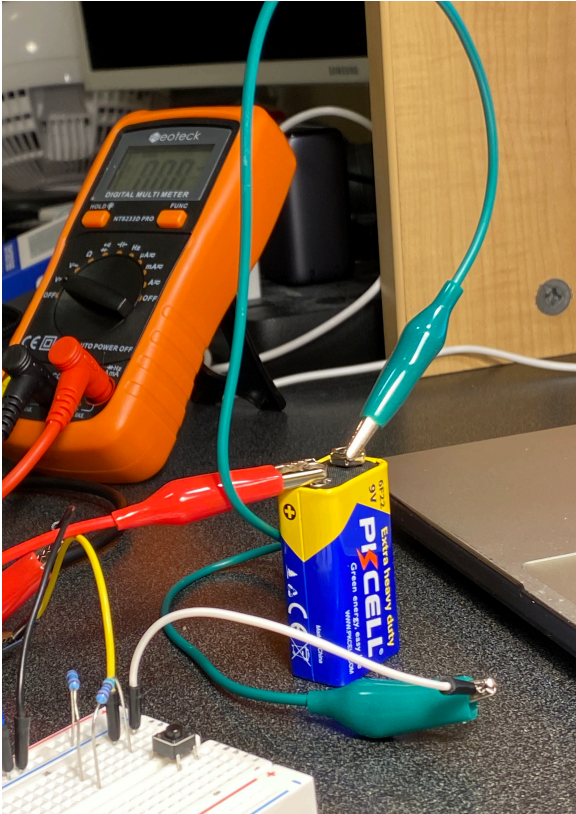


Figure 2: Image of the experimental setup.

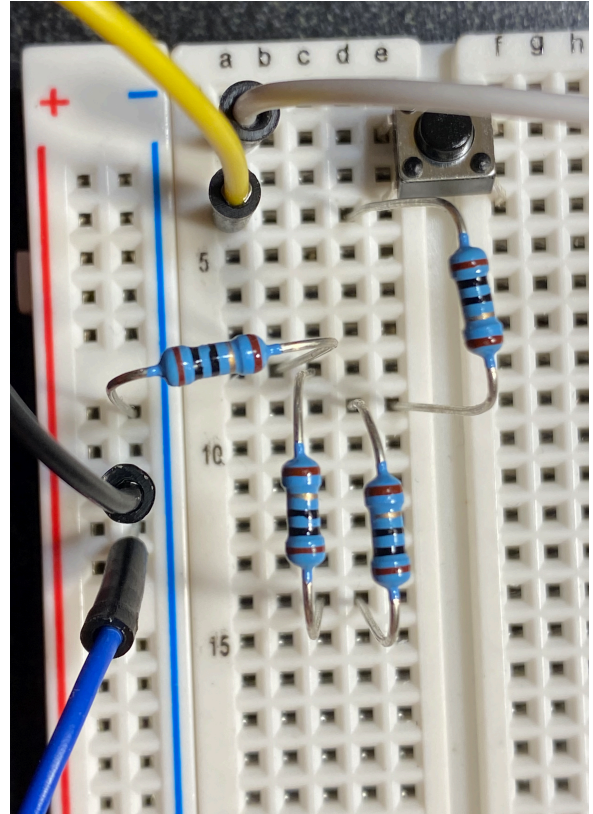


Figure 3: An image of the tissue box that was dropped onto the sensor

1.2. I-V Curve

Include a figure that shows the I-V curve for a resistance of varying value connected to a 9V battery. Fit the curve and give the internal resistance of the battery in the caption. You can include fit parameters in the plot or in the caption.

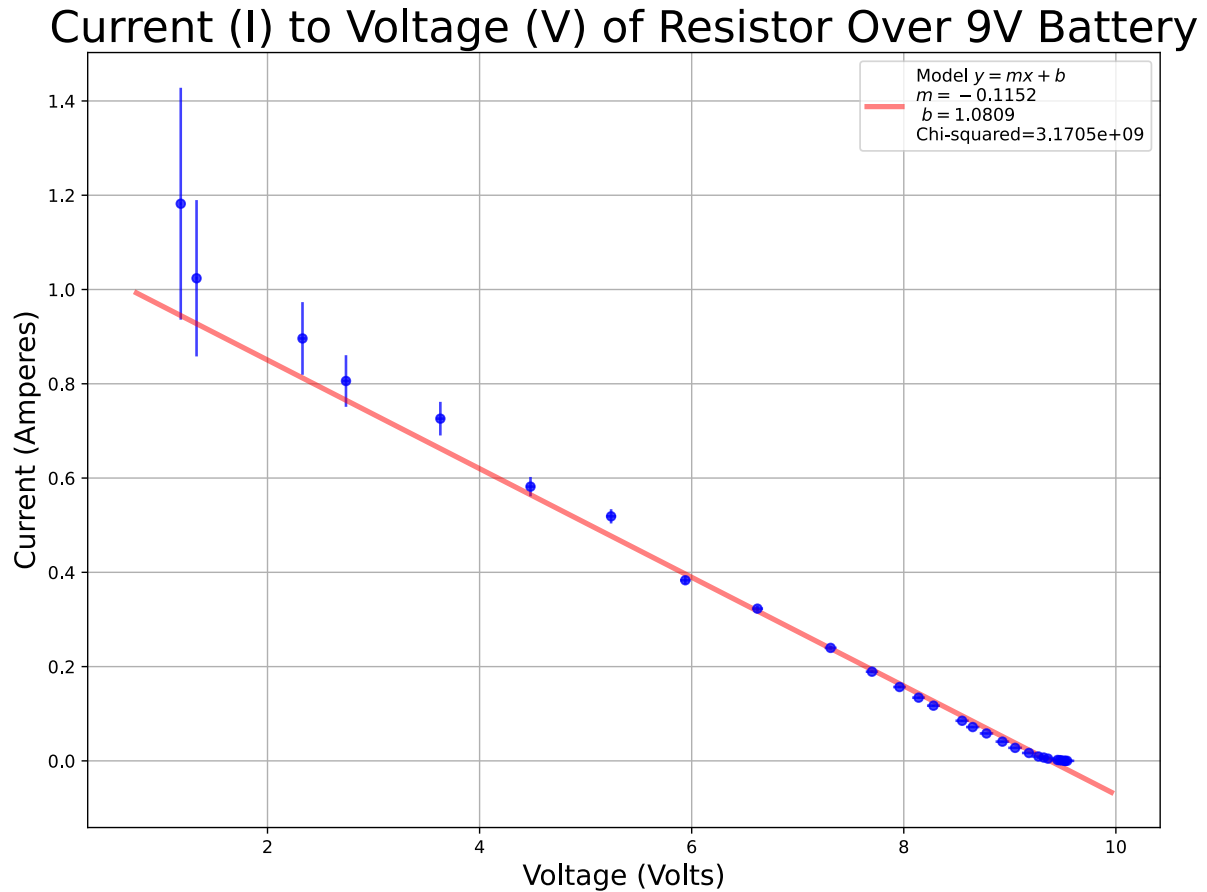


Figure 4: Current to voltage of
Internal Resistance = 8.6773 ± 0.1686

Finish this

Current (I) to Voltage (V) of Resistor Over 9V Battery

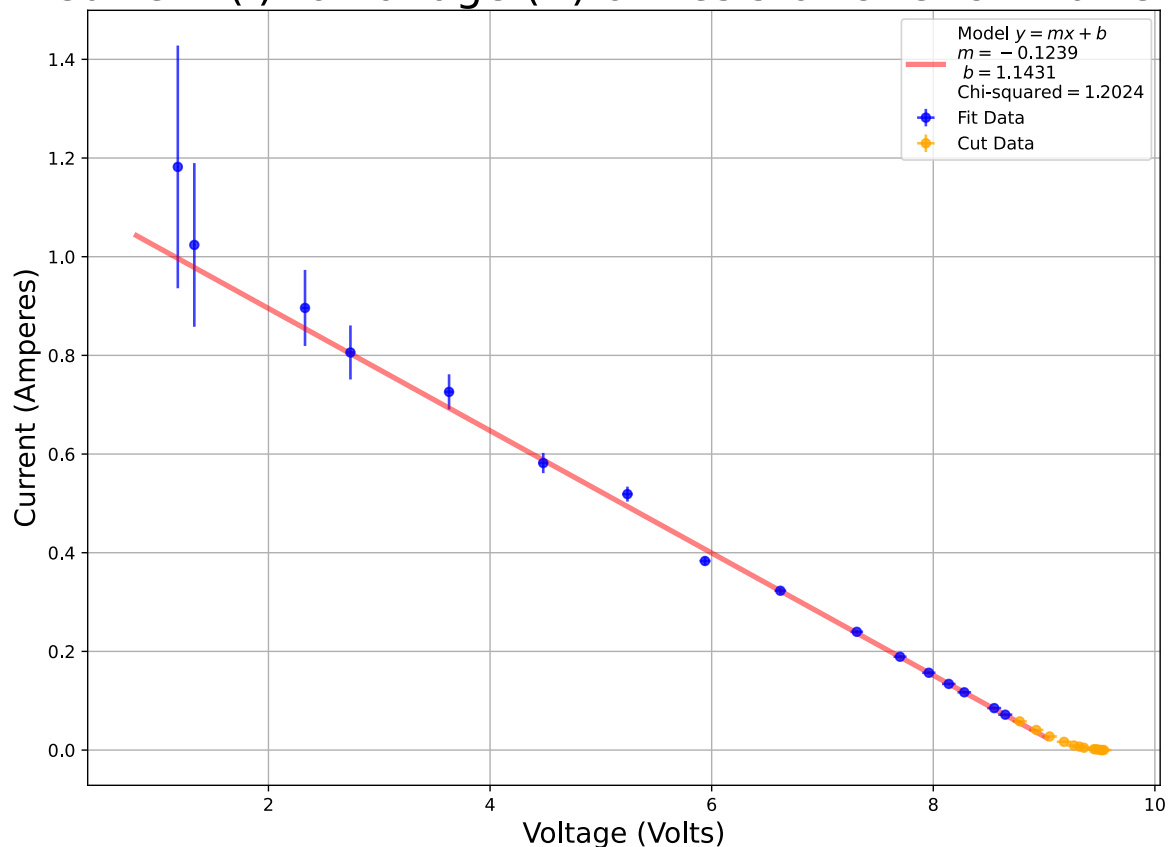


Figure 5: Current to voltage of Internal Resistance = 8.0690 ± 0.1369

Finish this

1.3. Internal Resistance of Voltmeter

[100 words max] Briefly comment on any marked deviation from the expected linear fit and if the obtained value of the internal resistance is reasonable.

The data was fit using Orthogonal distance regression using the `scipy.odr` library as it accounted for errors in both the dependant in independent variable.

There was a marked deviation when using a resistance over the battery was greater than 150.8 Ohms. At this point, current seemed to level out instead of following the linear trend.

This is demonstrated by cutting the data before this point, reducing the chi-squared from 3170457191.1117 to 1.2024.

The obtained value of internal resistance is reasonable, as is in the range of other batteries (0.006 - 35 Ohms). However, compared to the listed value for zinc carbon (which the battery is), it is out of range.

https://www.learningaboutelectronics.com/Articles/Battery-internal-resistance#google_vignette

Words: 114

2. Voltmeter internal resistance

2.1. Methodology

[100 words max] Briefly explain your methodology (e.g. why you picked the capacitor you picked, how you recorded the time-dependent data, how you determined your uncertainties)

As shown in [Figure 6](#), an arduino was used to sample the voltage roughly every 10 milliseconds. 1 μF was chosen as it provided a long enough decay when measuring the DMM to gather enough data, while ensuring runs did not produce too much data. A voltage divider was used to step down the voltage from 0-9.48V to 4.74V.

Uncertainty was propagated from the listed values for the Analogue to Digital Converter of the Arduino's ATmega328P (± 2 LSB absolute accuracy)¹. Voltage measurements were calibrated from the arduino's 3.3V reference pin.

Words: 92

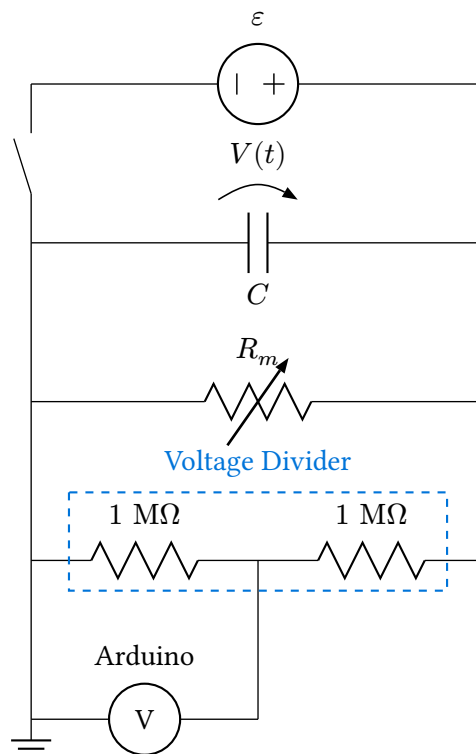


Figure 6: A circuit diagram of the setup.

The resistance R_r was varied during calibration to obtain a more precise value for the capacitance C , then swapped with the DMM to determine its internal resistance.

We need to take care to also account for the resistance caused by the voltage divider.

Let R_T represent the total resistance over the capacitor. From the circuit diagram, we can see:

¹https://ww1.microchip.com/downloads/en/DeviceDoc/Atmel-7810-Automotive-Microcontrollers-ATmega328P_Datasheet.pdf

“Define the variables here”

$$R_T = \frac{1}{\left(\frac{1}{R_r}\right) + \left(\frac{1}{1\text{ M}\Omega + 1\text{ M}\Omega}\right)}$$

$$R_r = \frac{1}{\left(\frac{1}{R_T}\right) - \left(\frac{1}{1\text{ M}\Omega + 1\text{ M}\Omega}\right)}$$

The time decay of voltage in an RC circuit is:

$$V(t) = V_0 e^{-\frac{t}{RC}}$$

$$\log(V(t)) = \log(V_0) + \left(-\frac{1}{RC}\right)t$$

Where $V(T)$ is the voltage at time t

Let V_{ard} equal the voltage detected by the arduino.

For the voltage divider circuit:

$$V = IR$$

$$V(t) = I(1\text{ M}\Omega + 1\text{ M}\Omega)$$

$$V_{\text{ard}} = I(1\text{ M}\Omega)$$

$$V_{\text{ard}} = \frac{V(t)}{1\text{ M}\Omega + 1\text{ M}\Omega}(1\text{ M}\Omega) = \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)V(t)$$

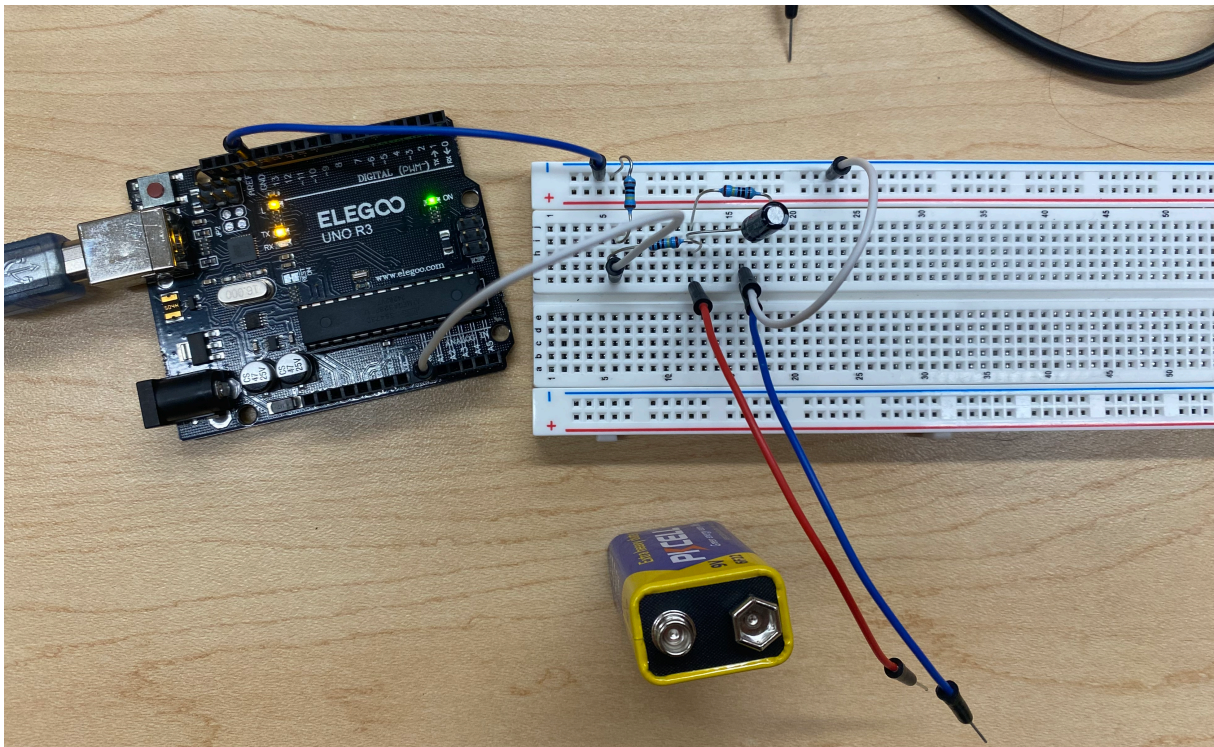


Figure 7: The experimental setup.

2.2. Discharge Voltage vs Time Curve

Include a figure that shows the discharge voltage vs time of a capacitor connected to your voltmeter. Fit the curve and give the time constant and value of the internal resistance of your voltmeter in the caption. You can include fit parameters in the plot or in the caption.

Voltage Decay of Capacitor in RC Circuit

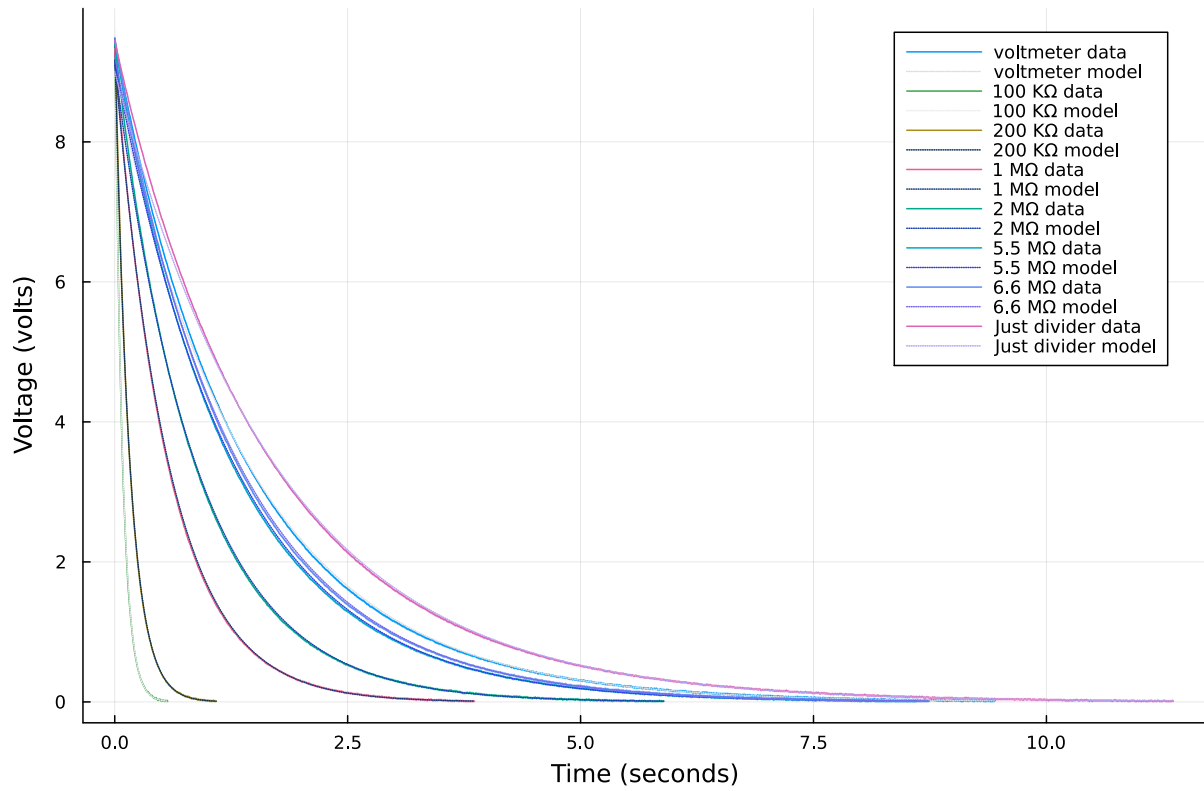


Figure 8:

Log of Voltage Decay of Capacitor in RC Circuit

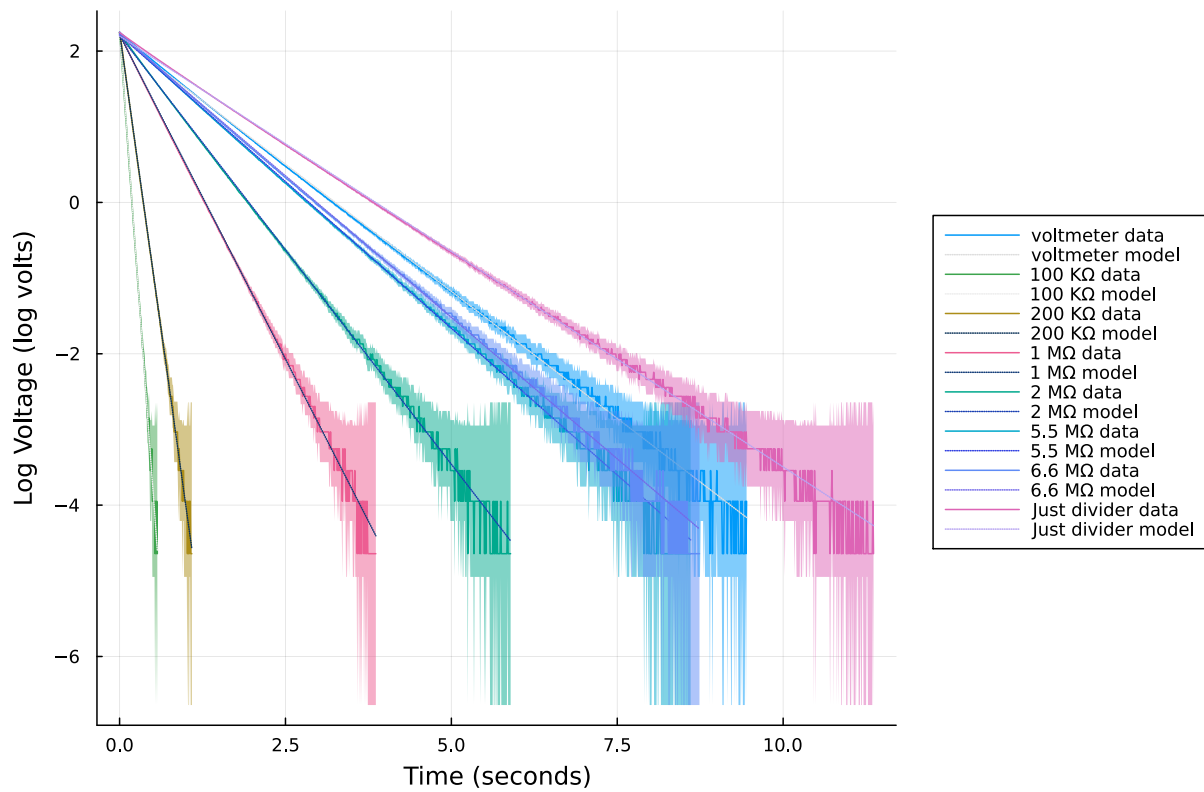


Figure 9:

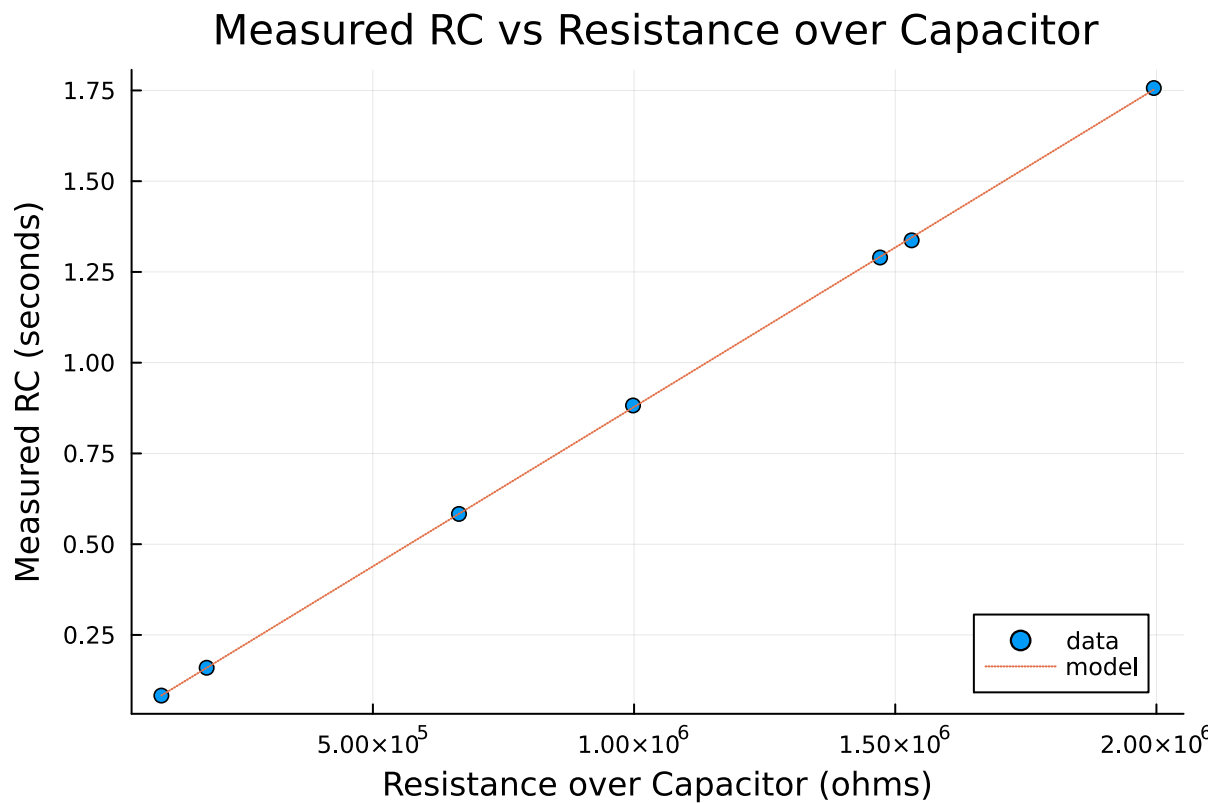


Figure 10:

2.3. Voltmeter Internal Resistance

[100 words max] Briefly comment on if the obtained value of the internal resistance is reasonable and on the implication of your results when making measurements with your voltmeter.

As shown in [Figure 10](#), by plotting the measured RC value to the expected resistance of the circuit and fitting a linear curve, C can be determined with greater precision. I found $C = 0.8784 \text{ uf} \pm 0.0020 \text{ uf}$ a difference of 0.1216 uf from the marked value.

We can divide the voltmeter's RC with C to determine R_T , then use the parallel resistance equation with uncertainty propagation, to get a voltmeter resistance of $11.264160 \text{ M}\Omega \pm 0.001996 \text{ M}\Omega$

The obtained value of the internal resistance of the voltmeter is reasonable, as it matches the measurement made by another multimeter $11.10 \text{ M}\Omega \pm 0.131 \text{ M}\Omega$.

This implies that whenever you make a measurement with the voltmeter, you are really measuring a system in parallel with an 11 $\text{M}\Omega$ resistor.

Words: 102

A Fit Parameters

I found that all the fit parameters really cluttered up the graphs, so I have included them in a table here.

Chi-squared were quite bad across the board. This implies that either the uncertainties were underestimated, or that the model did not reflect the actual discharge characteristics. I believe it is the latter case, as by looking at the residuals, they are clearly patterned.

This could also be due to the integral non-linearity of the arduino's Analogue to Digital Converter which is not taken into account in the uncertainties.

Nevertheless, fit uncertainties were quite low.